https://edocs.imo.org/Final Documents/English/MEPC 68-21-ADD.1 (E).doc
2.7 A slow and deep (>100 m) clockwise eddy, originating from the East Australian

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
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2.7 A slow and deep (>100 m) clockwise eddy, originating from the East Australian Current, circulates around the Marion Plateau. A similar gyre system of ocean currents exists atop the Queensland Plateau. The flow of these localized features is thought to create a barrier to larval dispersal that contributes to the high species endemism and localized distribution of species in the region.

2.8 The geomorphic characteristics of the coral reefs and cays reflect the constant exposure to high energy wind and wave conditions. The East Australian Current and its associated eddy fields are large scale, spatially predictable, ecologically important pelagic features represented in the region.

Other information

2.9 The Coral Sea's ecology is largely shaped by physical forces such as climate and weather patterns, the direction and strength of currents, the shape of the underlying seabed, and the interaction between water movement and seafloor topography. These forces affect

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
weather patterns, the direction and strength of currents, the shape of the underlying seabed, and the interaction between water movement and seafloor topography. These forces affect the distribution of species, the availability of nutrients and prey, the levels of disturbance experienced by ecological communities and their ability to recover from natural and human pressures and impacts.

2.10 In addition to the shipwrecks mentioned in annex 2, there have also been a number of incidents and near misses in the region in recent years that demonstrate the potential risk of environmental harm by ships that conduct their passage through the waters of the PSSA extension. Several case studies on near misses in recent years are provided in appendix 3 of document MEPC 68/10/1.

RESOLUTION MEPC.268(68)
(adopted on 15 May 2015)
DESIGNATION OF THE SOUTH-WEST CORAL SEA AS AN EXTENSION OF THE GREAT BARRIER REEF AND

https://edocs.imo.org/Final Documents/English/MEPC 68-21-ADD.1 (E).doc
ANNEX 4

ASSOCIATED PROTECTIVE MEASURES FOR THE GREAT BARRIER REEF, TORRES STRAIT AND CORAL SEA PSSA

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf

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ANNEX 4

ASSOCIATED PROTECTIVE MEASURES FOR THE GREAT BARRIER REEF, TORRES STRAIT AND CORAL SEA PSSA

Recommendatory Associated Protective Measures (APMs) are:

.1 An area to be avoided (ATBA) encompassing the reefs, shoals, and islets that lie generally to the north-east of the GBR, between Palm and Hydrographers Passage. Keeping transiting SOLAS ships clear of this area will mitigate the risk of groundings and allow more time for intervention, in case of developing situations (e.g. a ship suffering breakdown of its propulsion machinery) (see appendix 3 of document MEPC 68/10/1 for further information);

.2 Two 5 nautical mile wide two-way routes one in Diamond Passage and the other to the West of Holmes Reef in the south-west Coral Sea.

.1 The two-way route in Diamond Passage extends from approximately 25 nautical miles south of Diamond Passage through to approximately 35 nautical miles north of the passage.

.2 The two-way route West of Holmes Reef extends for 32.5 nautical miles approximately north west of Holmes Reef and 20.5 nautical

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
through to approximately 35 nautical miles north of the passage.

.2 The two-way route West of Holmes Reef extends for 32.5 nautical miles approximately north west of Holmes Reef and 20.5 nautical miles approximately south west of Holmes Reef; and

.3 The proposed two-way routes aim to reduce the risks of collision and grounding of ships by separating opposing streams of traffic, whilst ensuring ships avoid the shoals, reef and islands that lie

close outside the two-way routes. The two-way routes also aim to allow ships to follow well-defined lanes, thereby enhancing the safety and efficiency of navigation through effective passage planning. (see appendix 4 of document MEPC 68/10/1 for further information).

The APMs are new ships' routeing systems under SOLAS regulation V/10 and are provided in full in appendices 3 and 4 of document MEPC 68/10/1 and depicted in the chartlets below.

DESCRIPTION OF THE TWO-WAY ROUTES AND ASSOCIATED CHARTLETS IN THE CORAL SEA

The ship routeing systems consist of two recommendatory two-way routes in the south-west portion of the Coral Sea, each being five nautical miles wide.

Diamond Passage

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SOURCE: MEPC.268(68).pdf
IN THE CORAL SEA

The ship routeing systems consist of two recommendatory two-way routes in the south-west portion of the Coral Sea, each being five nautical miles wide.

Diamond Passage

The Diamond Passage two-way route starts approximately south east of South Diamond Islet and extends on a bearing of 019-199 degrees for 24.5 nautical miles. It then changes to a bearing of 008-188 degrees for 35 nautical miles.

From the two-way route's centreline, the closest distance to the 100 metre bathymetric contour is approximately 6.9 nautical miles in both east and west directions. This means that the passage width between those contours, at its narrowest, is approximately 13.8 nautical miles.
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West of Holmes Reef

The Holmes Reef two-way route commences west of Flora Reef and extends along a

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West of Holmes Reef

The Holmes Reef two-way route commences west of Flora Reef and extends along a bearing of 012-192 degrees for 20.5 nautical miles. The bearing changes to 040-220 degrees for 32.5 nautical miles. Holmes Reefs and Flora Reef are over 10 nautical miles from the eastern limit of the two-way route.